European Operational Program for Exchange of Weather Radar Information (OPERA)

OPERA production data and software release 2026b

Prepared by:	H.Leijnse, V. Meyer, M. Radojevic, K. Stephan, and A. von Lerber
Project:	OPERA Production release 2026b
Production Centre:	DWD, GeoSphere Austria, KNMI and Météo-France
Application Domain:	CUMULUS, STRATUS, CIRRUS and NIMBUS production
Processing Software:	CIRRUS 1.7.0 (including BALTRAD version dated 2025-10-01), NIMBUS (including BALTRAD version 3.1.0, dated 2026-06-09) NIMBUS

Reference	Date	Author(s)	Content
OPERA_release_notes_20261028	14.09.2026	Annakaisa von Lerber	First draft
OPERA_release_notes_CIRRUS-1.7	28.10.2026	Milka Radojevic	CIRRUS production
OPERA_release_notes_20261028_GSA	29.10.2026	Vera Meyer	NIMBUS production
OPERA_release_notes_20261102	02.11.2026	Annakaisa von Lerber	final version for commenting
OPERA_release_notes_20261102_GSA_KS	02.11.2026	Klaus Stephan	added comments

1. OPERA production data release 2026b

1. Data update
   - 6 new radars existing sites in Spain (AEMET). Please note change in the node name:
     - LEMM41 (renamed node from eslid to esatp)
     - LEMM43 (renamed node from esval to escll)
     - LEMM44 (renamed node from esmur to esftn)
     - LEMM46 (renamed node from escor to esccd)
     - LEMM48 (renamed node from essan to essls)
     - LEMM54 (renamed node from espma to esllm
   - 1 new radar new site in Spain (AEMET): LEMM63 (node=esgrm)
   - 1 new radar existing site in France (Météo France): LFPW64 (node=frche)

2. Update of filenames
   - Renaming reflectivity volume files with the incoming data for Belgium radars: EBUM41, EBUM42 & EBUM43
     - Belgium previously delivered four reflectivity products (TH, wind-optimised DBZH, best DBZH, and Doppler-filtered DBZH). Following a filename convention change, delivery of the Doppler-filtered DBZH products has been discontinued.

3. Data updates (not affecting CIRRUS production)
   - New data processing, transmission & elevations for all radars in Finland (FMI):
     - EFKL wind-optimized scans available (except the lowest elevation angle 0.7°) in wind profile production and in QC volumes
     - EFKL wind-optimized scan (lowest elevation angle 0.7°) available without NIMBUS QC in 15 min - QC volumes
   - Elevation angle change for one radar in Hungary (HungaroMet):
     - HABP43 with new elevation angle (node=hunap)
   - HABP wind-optimized scans available without NIMBUS QC in 15 min - QC volumes
   - Change in radial resolution for three radars and additions of parameters in QC-volumes in Poland (IMGW):
     - for all SOWR radars new parameters included in QC volume files (DBZH, VRADH, and TH)
     - 3 SOWR radars with rscale changed from 1000m to 500m (SOWR46 (node= plswi), 49 (node = pluzr), and 50 (node = plgsa))
   - Notes to Belgium incoming data
     - Changes in filenames required reconfiguration in NIMBUS
     - Reflectivities for wind-optimized scans are available without NIMBUS QC in 15 min - QC volumes (as before)
     - The QC'ed volumes files will change, due to the discontinue of the Doppler-filtered DBZH

Commented [Gu1]: Maybe "Data exchange update" is more inclusive.

2. OPERA production software release 2026b

Commented [Gu2]: I think the subsection names of section 2.1, 2.2., and 2.3 need to be aligned.

1. CUMULUS and STRATUS
    - RMDCN data transfer to CUMULUS is shut down by the end of December 2026.

2. CIRRUS (version 1.7.0)
    - No software updates

3. NIMBUS
    - No changes in data process chain

4. Open Radar Data API
    - migration to new European Weather Cloud infrastructure on November 24th (separate release notes)

Contact

OPERA support: support.opera@eumetnet.eu

Supportive documents:

Example composite files can be found: https://github.com/opera-radar/opera-releases/tree/main/examples/example_files_release_2026b